

Restore

Fire & Smoke Damage SOP

CONFIDENTIAL - FOR EMPLOYEE USE ONLY

Last Updated: April 2026

Initial Site Assessment

Fire and smoke damage requires careful assessment before any work begins:

1. Confirm structure has been cleared by the fire department
2. Check for structural integrity - do not enter if compromised
3. Test for electrical hazards and ensure power is disconnected
4. Identify types of residue: dry smoke, wet smoke, protein, fuel/oil
5. Document all conditions thoroughly with photos and notes
6. Create detailed scope of work including contents inventory

Smoke & Soot Removal

Cleaning methods depend on the type of smoke residue:

Dry Smoke (fast-burning, high temp): Dry sponge first, then wet clean. Residue is powdery and easier to remove.

Wet Smoke (slow-burning, low temp): Requires degreasing agents. Residue is sticky and smeared. Most difficult to clean.

Protein Residue (kitchen fires): Nearly invisible but strong odor. Requires enzyme-based cleaners.

Always clean from top to bottom, working in sections. HEPA vacuum before wet cleaning.

Odor Elimination

Smoke odor elimination requires multi-step treatment:

1. Remove the source - all charred and heavily damaged materials
2. Clean all surfaces to remove residue
3. Apply thermal fogging for penetrating odors
4. Use hydroxyl generators or ozone treatment for persistent odors
5. Seal surfaces with odor-blocking primer/sealer

NOTE: Ozone treatment requires area to be unoccupied. Follow all safety protocols.